

Business Agent Harness Framework

Executive summary

A Business Agent Harness gives a company a safe way to use AI agents inside normal work.

Instead of staff privately experimenting with random AI tools, the business gets a shared operating room where:

- staff ask for help in approved Discord channels,
- agents respond within defined permissions,
- managers can see what happened,
- approvals are visible before risky actions,
- daily summaries and receipts create accountability.

The goal is not to replace staff. The goal is to remove bottlenecks, reduce repetitive admin, and give people a reliable support layer for research, drafting, checking, reporting, and operational follow-up.

What the harness includes

Layer	What it does	Client benefit
Discord operating room	Shared channels for requests, approvals, reports, and support	Everyone can see the work instead of losing context in private chats
Agent roster	Named agents with defined jobs and limits	Staff know which agent to ask and what it can safely do
Permission model	Role-based access for users and bots	Agents only see and do what they need
Human approval gates	Clear rules before external, financial, customer, or destructive actions	Control stays with the business
Memory and receipts	Summaries, task logs, decision records, and handovers	The system improves without becoming a black box
Monitoring	Daily reports, error channels, and escalation paths	Problems are visible early

Example business setup

For most small and mid-sized businesses, start with five channels:

Channel	Purpose	Who can use it
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#agent-helpdesk	General staff requests	All approved staff
#approvals	Manager sign-off before sensitive actions	Managers + agents
#daily-briefings	Daily summary of what happened	Staff read, agents post
#agent-reports	Longer reports, audits, and handovers	Managers + operators
#incident-log	Errors, blocked actions, security concerns	Managers + maintainer

Then add department channels only when needed, such as #sales-agent, #ops-agent, #admin-agent, Or #marketing-agent.

Example agent roster

Agent	Best for	Should not do without approval
Coordinator Agent	Routes requests, summarizes work, checks status	Make public commitments or change permissions
Research Agent	Competitor research, supplier lookup, source summaries	Contact vendors, scrape private data, cite weak sources as fact
Admin Agent	Draft emails, SOPs, forms, checklists	Send email, delete records, access payroll/HR without explicit scope
Reporting Agent	Daily/weekly reports, metrics summaries	Change dashboards or publish metrics externally
Customer Support Drafting Agent	Draft replies and classify themes	Send final customer responses unless approved

Permission philosophy: small keyrings

A safe business agent should have the smallest set of keys needed for its job.

Good permission design:

- read-only before write access,
- one department before whole company access,
- draft-only before send/publish authority,
- manager approval before customer, payment, legal, HR, or public actions,
- separate owner/admin permissions from day-to-day user permissions.

Rollout phases

Phase	Duration	Goal	Success sign
0. Discovery	Before install	Map teams, tools, risks, and use cases	Clear first 3 workflows chosen
1. Safe room	Day 1	Discord server, roles, channels, agents, approvals	Staff can ask and receive safe help

2. Assisted workflows	Week 1–2	Agents draft, research, summarize, report	Managers see useful receipts
3. Limited tool access	Week 2–4	Carefully connect business tools	No blind automation; approvals work
4. Operating rhythm	Month 2+	Daily summaries, weekly tuning, training	Staff trust the system and use it naturally

What actions require approval

Always require a named human approval before an agent:

- sends emails or customer replies,
- posts publicly,
- changes website/live systems,
- modifies financial, legal, HR, or payroll records,
- invites users or changes permissions,
- deletes data,
- buys software or spends money,
- exports customer data,
- contacts external suppliers/customers.

Client responsibilities

The business must provide:

- one business owner or executive sponsor,
- one operational champion,
- list of users and departments,
- approved first workflows,
- access owner for each business system,
- permission decisions before tools are connected,
- staff availability for training.

Deliverables from the installation

By the end of the install, the client should have:

- a configured Discord server,
- staff roles and manager roles,
- agent/bot roles and channels,
- an approval workflow,
- example prompts and request templates,
- daily briefing/report channels,

- a first agent roster,
 - acceptance test results,
 - training guide for staff.
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Success metrics

Track early value with simple indicators:

- requests handled per week,
 - staff time saved on repetitive drafting/research/admin,
 - number of tasks requiring manager approval,
 - number of blocked unsafe requests,
 - average response time,
 - top recurring request types,
 - unresolved incidents or access blockers.
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Plain-English safety promise

Agents can help the business move faster, but they should not become invisible employees with unlimited access. The harness keeps AI work visible, reviewable, and permissioned.
